

THE UGC HOOK BANK

100+ UGC HOOKS

128 proven spoken and visual hooks for product, website, and app videos. Fill in the blank, film, post.

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BEFORE YOU FILM

WHAT IS A HOOK?

A hook is the first few seconds of your video. Its only job is to stop the scroll.

THE RULE

WHY IT MATTERS

01.	Fill every blank	Swap each [bracket] for something specific. Real numbers, real timeframes, real product details.
02.	Say it up front	The hook is the first line. Say it out loud and put it on screen as text, too.
03.	Match the visual	Give them something to watch while you talk. Start mid-action: setting your phone down, setting the product out, opening the app.
04.	Pay it off	Whatever the hook promises, the video has to deliver. Otherwise viewers swipe and stop trusting you.
05.	Test more than one	Film two or three hooks for the same video.

FILL IN THE BLANK, WORD FOR WORD

"I tried [product] for [time]. Here's what happened."

becomes "I tried this meal delivery service for a week. Here's what happened."

Brackets are placeholders. The more specific you make them, the better the hook performs.

HOOKS FOR

VISUAL HOOKS

What viewers see in the first second matters as much as what they hear. Pair any spoken hook below with one of these.

THE VISUAL + HOW TO FILM IT

- | | |
|---|---|
| 01. Setting down your phone
Start the video as you set the phone down. It feels like you just hit record on something real. | 02. Stirring your drink
Stir an iced coffee or matcha while you say your first line. |
| 03. Pouring into your drink
Pour in milk, creamer or a drink mix. The swirl is satisfying to watch. | 04. Cutting fruit
Slice fruit or prep food while you talk. Busy hands keep eyes on screen. |
| 05. Food in front of you
Start with a plate in frame or mid-bite. | 06. Opening or closing your laptop
Open the lid to reveal the screen. Perfect for apps and websites. |
| 07. Fidget toys
Squish slime or spin a fidget spinner. Oddly satisfying motion stops the thumb. | 08. Microphone or AirPods
Talk into a mini mic or pop an AirPods in. Reads like a podcast or a real update. |
| 09. Eye-catching elements
A bright color, bold outfit or unexpected object in frame. | 10. Long shot, slow zoom
Film wide, then slowly zoom in on you. Builds anticipation. |
| 11. Multitasking
Talk while doing something else: makeup, folding laundry, packing a bag. | 12. Prop or visual
Hold up the product, a screenshot or a receipt. Show what you're talking about. |
| 13. Whiteboard
Write on or point to a whiteboard. Instantly says "I'm teaching you something." | 14. Mirror
Film in or through a mirror. Natural for beauty, fashion and fitness. |
| 15. Walking in or out of frame
Walk into the shot, or start walking away from the camera. | 16. Catching something
Catch the product, or something tossed to you, as the video starts. |
| 17. Sitting down or standing up
Sit down or stand up as you start talking to the camera. The movement pulls viewers in. | |
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Start mid-action. Never start still.

HOOKS FOR

CURIOSITY

Open a gap the viewer needs closed. They stay to get the answer.

THE HOOK

EXAMPLE

18.	What no one tells you about <i>[product]</i> ...	What no one tells you about switching to a budgeting app...
19.	The surprising truth about <i>[product category]</i> ...	The surprising truth about natural deodorant...
20.	Things I wish I knew before buying <i>[product]</i> ...	Things I wish I knew before buying a standing desk.
21.	I was today years old when I found out <i>[product]</i> could <i>[feature]</i> .	I was today years old when I found out my notes app could transcribe meetings.
22.	If you think <i>[product]</i> is just for <i>[common use]</i> , think again.	If you think a rice cooker is just for rice, think again.
23.	The real reason everyone's obsessed with <i>[product]</i> ...	The real reason everyone's obsessed with this water bottle...
24.	Watch what happens after <i>[time]</i> of using <i>[product]</i> . Wait until the end.	Watch my skin after 30 days of this serum. Wait until the end.
25.	Ever wondered what would happen if you used <i>[product]</i> for <i>[time]</i> ?	Ever wondered what would happen if you used a sunrise alarm for a month?
26.	Nobody's talking about <i>[product]</i> , and I don't get why.	Nobody's talking about this budgeting app, and I don't get why.
27.	You won't see this anywhere else about <i>[product]</i> ...	You won't see this anywhere else about the real benefits of probiotics...

Tease the answer. Never give it away in the first line.

HOOKS FOR

MISTAKES & WARNINGS

Nobody wants to be doing it wrong. Name the mistake and they'll stay to check.

THE HOOK

EXAMPLE

28.	Don't make this mistake with <i>[product]</i> .	Don't make this mistake with your first air fryer.
29.	The one mistake that's costing you <i>[money/time]</i> on <i>[category]</i> ...	The one mistake that's costing you hundreds on skincare...
30.	If you're doing this with <i>[product]</i> , you're wasting <i>[money/time]</i> .	If you're doing this with your meal kit, you're wasting money.
31.	Most people are using <i>[product]</i> wrong.	Most people are using their makeup brushes wrong.
32.	I've been using <i>[product]</i> wrong my whole life.	I've been using my hair straightener wrong my whole life.
33.	If you do this with <i>[product]</i> , stop immediately.	If you're still saving passwords in your notes app, stop immediately.
34.	3 things to avoid if you want <i>[result]</i> .	3 things to avoid if you want your nails to last two weeks.
35.	Don't spend another dollar on <i>[product type]</i> until you see this.	Don't spend another dollar on face cream until you see this.
36.	The #1 mistake people make with <i>[activity]</i> .	The #1 mistake people make with shaving.

Make the mistake specific enough that the viewer wonders if it's them.

HOOKS FOR

MYTHS & BOLD CLAIMS

Take a side. A confident opinion stops the scroll faster than a neutral one.

THE HOOK

EXAMPLE

37.	The internet convinced us <i>[belief]</i>, but I'm here to tell you <i>[truth]</i>.	The internet convinced us protein powder tastes bad, but I'm here to tell you it doesn't.
38.	Here's why I changed my mind about <i>[product/belief]</i>.	Here's why I changed my mind about meal delivery apps.
39.	Why you should stop listening to <i>[common advice]</i> about <i>[category]</i>.	Why you should stop listening to the advice to skip toner.
40.	Hottest take of the year: <i>[opinion about category]</i>.	Hottest take of the year: you don't need a 10-step skincare routine.
41.	Whoever said <i>[claim]</i> clearly never tried <i>[product]</i>.	Whoever said budgeting is boring clearly never tried this app.
42.	This might ruin <i>[old product]</i> for you, but <i>[new product]</i>...	This might ruin regular pillowcases for you, but silk...
43.	You say you have the best <i>[product]</i>, but is it missing <i>[feature]</i>?	You say you have the best planner app, but does it sync with your calendar?
44.	Show me a better <i>[product]</i>. I'll wait.	Show me a better travel steamer. I'll wait.
45.	This is a hill I'm willing to die on: <i>[product claim]</i>.	This is a hill I'm willing to die on: this is the only mascara that doesn't smudge.
46.	We've been doing <i>[task]</i> wrong this whole time.	We've been loading the dishwasher wrong this whole time.

Commit to the claim. Then let the product back it up.

HOOKS FOR

RESULTS & TRANSFORMATION

Show the before and promise the after. The viewer stays to see how you got there.

THE HOOK	EXAMPLE
47. Here's how I went from <i>[problem]</i> to <i>[result]</i> with <i>[product]</i> .	Here's how I went from acne-prone to clear skin with this routine.
48. How I got <i>[result]</i> in just <i>[time frame]</i> .	How I got better sleep in just one week with this pillow.
49. <i>[#]</i> things I learned after <i>[#]</i> weeks of using <i>[product]</i> .	5 things I learned after 3 weeks of using this language app.
50. This small change had a huge impact on my <i>[result]</i> .	This small change to my morning coffee had a huge impact on my energy.
51. How I <i>[achieved result]</i> without <i>[typical requirement]</i> .	How I cleared my skin without expensive treatments.
52. Here's what finally worked after years of trying to <i>[goal]</i> .	Here's what finally worked after years of trying to stick to a budget.
53. The fastest way to get <i>[result]</i> with <i>[product]</i> .	The fastest way to get salon-quality hair at home.
54. This was my biggest wake-up call about <i>[problem]</i> .	This was my biggest wake-up call about how much I spend on takeout.
55. The most powerful thing I learned after <i>[time]</i> with <i>[product]</i> .	The most powerful thing I learned after 6 months with this fitness app.
56. Here's what <i>[time]</i> of using <i>[product]</i> actually looks like.	Here's what 30 days of using this language app actually looks like.

Specific numbers and timeframes make results believable.

HOOKS FOR

HONEST REVIEW

Sound like a real person testing it, not an ad. Skepticism builds trust.

THE HOOK

EXAMPLE

57.	I tried <i>[product]</i> for <i>[time]</i> . Here's what happened.	I tried this meal delivery service for a week. Here's what happened.
58.	I didn't believe it until I tried <i>[product]</i> myself.	I didn't believe it until I tried this vegan protein myself.
59.	I tried to talk myself out of buying <i>[product]</i> , but...	I tried to talk myself out of buying this robot vacuum, but...
60.	I'm lowkey embarrassed it took me this long to try <i>[product]</i> .	I'm lowkey embarrassed it took me this long to try a password manager.
61.	My biggest regret is not trying <i>[product]</i> sooner.	My biggest regret is not buying a good blender sooner.
62.	What I discovered after trying <i>[product]</i> ...	What I discovered after trying this plant-based protein...
63.	Is <i>[product]</i> actually worth it? Let's find out.	Is this \$40 water bottle actually worth it? Let's find out.
64.	I bought the viral <i>[product]</i> so you don't have to.	I bought the viral heatless curler so you don't have to.
65.	Here goes nothing: first time trying <i>[product]</i> .	Here goes nothing: first time trying a robot vacuum.
66.	I didn't expect <i>[product]</i> to <i>[surprising result]</i> .	I didn't expect a pillow to fix my neck pain.

Doubt first, then the reveal. That's what makes it feel real.

HOOKS FOR

SWITCHING & NEVER GOING BACK

Compare the old way to the new one. The viewer sees themselves in the old way.

THE HOOK

EXAMPLE

67.	Why I'll never go back to [old product] after trying [new product].	Why I'll never go back to regular toothpaste after trying this one.
68.	Why I'm ditching [common product] for [alternative].	Why I'm ditching paper planners for this app.
69.	Why I quit [old habit] and switched to [product].	Why I quit soda and switched to this sparkling tea.
70.	[Old way] vs. [product]. It's not even close.	Doing my taxes by hand vs. this app. It's not even close.
71.	I replaced [several things] with one [product].	I replaced three skincare products with this one serum.
72.	Why I'll never take [old advice] seriously again.	Why I'll never take fad diets seriously again.
73.	Goodbye, [old product]. Hello, [new product].	Goodbye, paper receipts. Hello, this expense app.
74.	I switched to [product] for [time]. Here's what changed.	I switched to a standing desk for a month. Here's what changed.

Name the old product they're still using. That's the hook.

HOOKS FOR

RECOMMENDATIONS

Speak to one person with one problem, and hand them the fix.

THE HOOK

EXAMPLE

75.	This is why I swear by [product].	This is why I swear by my silk pillowcase.
76.	If you haven't tried [product], you're missing out.	If you haven't tried this herbal tea, you're missing out.
77.	You need [product] in your life if you struggle with [problem].	You need this yoga mat in your life if you struggle to work out at home.
78.	If you're struggling with [problem], try this.	If you're struggling with frizzy hair, try this anti-humidity spray.
79.	If you're like me and [trait], you'll love this.	If you're like me and always forget to drink water, you'll love this bottle.
80.	Nothing is going to top this [product].	Nothing is going to top this travel bag.
81.	This is the blueprint for [goal], and no one can convince me otherwise.	This is the blueprint for meal prep, and no one can convince me otherwise.
82.	Why I use [product] every single day.	Why I use this collagen supplement every single day.
83.	If you only buy one [category] this year, make it this.	If you only buy one kitchen gadget this year, make it this.

The more specific the problem, the stronger the recommendation.

HOOKS FOR

HOW-TO & HACKS

Teach something useful in seconds. Saves and shares come from value.

THE HOOK

EXAMPLE

84.	This is how the pros use <i>[product]</i> .	This is how the pros use this kitchen gadget to save time.
85.	Here's the secret to <i>[result]</i> with <i>[product]</i> .	Here's the secret to glowing skin with one product.
86.	<i>[#]</i> hacks for <i>[product]</i> that changed everything.	5 hacks for this note-taking app that changed everything.
87.	If you want to get better at <i>[activity]</i> , start here.	If you want to get better at strength training, start here.
88.	Here's how to <i>[task]</i> the right way.	Here's how to meal prep the right way.
89.	What to do instead of <i>[common approach]</i> .	What to do instead of endless cardio.
90.	Here's how to start from scratch with <i>[product]</i> .	Here's how to start from scratch with your home gym setup.
91.	Here's how you can save <i>[money/time]</i> with <i>[product]</i> .	Here's how you can save an hour a week with this meal prep service.
92.	<i>[#]</i> steps to <i>[result]</i> with <i>[product]</i> .	3 steps to a better skincare routine with one cleanser.
93.	Save this for the next time you <i>[situation]</i> .	Save this for the next time you pack for a trip.

Lead with the payoff, then show the steps.

HOOKS FOR

REVERSE PSYCHOLOGY

Tell them it isn't for them. People hate being left out.

THE HOOK

EXAMPLE

94.	This is NOT for you if [condition].	This app is NOT for you if you like overspending.
95.	Scroll past this unless you're [target customer].	Scroll past this unless you're a busy mom who hates cooking.
96.	If you want to keep [problem], keep scrolling.	If you want to keep losing your keys, keep scrolling.
97.	Whatever you do, don't save this unless you want [result].	Whatever you do, don't save this unless you want clear skin.
98.	If you don't want [task] to get easier, skip this.	If you don't want cleaning to get easier, skip this.
99.	You might not want to watch this if you love your [old product].	You might not want to watch this if you love your old phone case.
100.	If you're already a [expert], this isn't for you.	If you're already a makeup pro, this isn't for you.
101.	Don't buy [product] unless you want [result].	Don't buy this pillow unless you want to sleep through your alarm.

Exclude the wrong viewer, and the right one leans in.

HOOKS FOR

STRAIGHT TALK

Say what others won't. Directness reads as honesty.

THE HOOK	EXAMPLE
102. I hate to be the one to tell you this, but <i>[truth]</i> .	I hate to be the one to tell you this, but your sunscreen isn't enough.
103. I'm not going to sugarcoat it: <i>[truth]</i> .	I'm not going to sugarcoat it: your mattress is why you're tired.
104. Can someone explain why <i>[product]</i> isn't more popular?	Can someone explain why this app isn't more popular?
105. You don't need <i>[expensive thing]</i> . What you need is <i>[product]</i> .	You don't need a gym membership. What you need is these resistance bands.
106. This is going to sound harsh, but <i>[truth]</i> .	This is going to sound harsh, but your skincare routine is too long.
107. You said you wanted the honest truth about <i>[product]</i> , so...	You said you wanted the honest truth about this viral blender, so...
108. I'm going to hurt my own feelings saying this, but <i>[truth]</i> .	I'm going to hurt my own feelings saying this, but my \$80 moisturizer did nothing.
109. The people who don't want to hear this need it the most: <i>[truth]</i> .	The people who don't want to hear this need it the most: you don't need more products.

Be blunt about the problem, warm about the solution.

HOOKS FOR

MID-SENTENCE

Start as if you're already mid-thought. The viewer feels like they caught something good.

THE HOOK

EXAMPLE

110.	...and the craziest part is <i>[surprising fact]</i> .	...and the craziest part is it only took five minutes.
111.	...but what they don't tell you is <i>[hidden detail]</i> .	...but what they don't tell you is the free version does all of this.
112.	...and the part nobody talks about is <i>[detail]</i> .	...and the part nobody talks about is how long it lasts.
113.	...and that's exactly the problem with <i>[old way]</i> .	...and that's exactly the problem with drugstore primer.
114.	...and that's where you're wrong, because <i>[fact]</i> .	...and that's where you're wrong, because this one's fragrance-free.
115.	So long story short, <i>[product]</i> <i>[result]</i> .	So long story short, this app paid for itself in a week.
116.	Since we're already on the topic, this is exactly why I use <i>[product]</i> .	Since we're already on the topic, this is exactly why I use this planner.
117.	...but honestly, that's when everything changed.	...but honestly, once I got this desk, that's when everything changed.

No intro, no hello. Drop them straight into the best part.

HOOKS FOR

APPS & WEBSITES

Made for Canvas and tech UGC. Show the screen, name the problem, let the app solve it.

THE HOOK	EXAMPLE
118. POV: you finally found an app that <i>[solves problem]</i> .	POV: you finally found an app that tracks every subscription you forgot about.
119. The app I didn't know I needed until <i>[moment]</i> .	The app I didn't know I needed until tax season.
120. Delete <i>[old app]</i> . Download <i>[new app]</i> . Thank me later.	Delete your notes app. Download this one. Thank me later.
121. This website does <i>[task]</i> in <i>[time]</i> , and it's free.	This website builds your resume in five minutes, and it's free.
122. Apps that feel illegal to know about: <i>[app]</i> .	Apps that feel illegal to know about: this one finds you cheaper flights.
123. If your phone doesn't have <i>[app type]</i> , fix that today.	If your phone doesn't have a budgeting app, fix that today.
124. I can't believe <i>[app]</i> is free.	I can't believe this photo editing app is free.
125. <i>[#]</i> things this app does that your <i>[default app]</i> doesn't.	3 things this calendar app does that your default calendar doesn't.
126. Me before <i>[app]</i> vs. me after <i>[app]</i> .	Me before this habit tracker vs. me after.
127. Stop scrolling. This app <i>[benefit]</i> .	Stop scrolling. This app turns your notes into flashcards.
128. The <i>[app category]</i> app everyone's switching to right now.	The budgeting app everyone's switching to right now.

Show the app working on screen within the first few seconds.

YOUR NEXT STEP

LET'S DO IT.

When you're in need of a new hook and struggling with creative direction, come back here and try one for your Canvas or traditional videos.

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